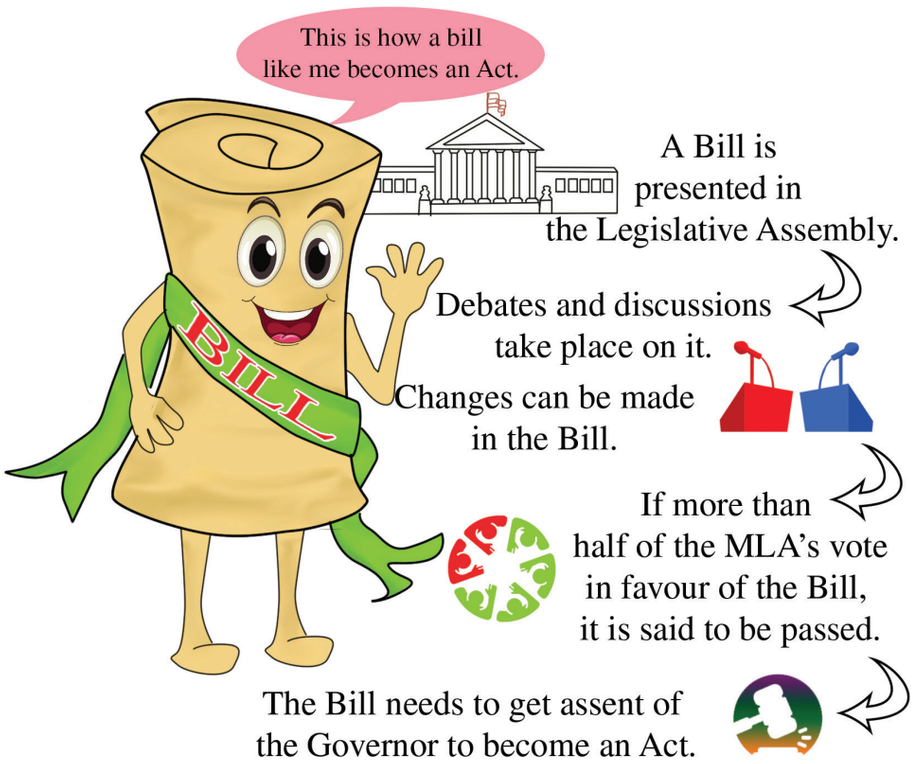


Acts related to women's rights

Various social reform movements constantly work for the development of women in India. As a result, many laws are being enacted to give women equal in legal status with men. When legal rights are denied for women, they can sue for redress. Hence legislation on women's rights plays an important role.

Many laws passed in our country provide rights and protection to women. Under the Sati Abolition Act -1829 the practice of burning the widow alive in the funeral pyre of her deceased husband was prohibited. The Prevention of Child Marriage Act -1929 (Sarada Act) banned the practice of child marriage. Widows were allowed to remarry under Widow Remarriage Act-1856.

The Hindu Succession Act-1956 ensured the right of the daughter to inherit the property of her parents. However, the Act did not ensure the right of female heirs to inherit the property of Hindu Undivided Family(HUF). So, it led to the evil practice of dowry and caused women to suffer a lot.

Keeping in view, a Bill was introduced and passed in the Tamilnadu Legislative Assembly in 1989 to amend The Hindu Succession Act -1956 to provide rights to women in Hindu Undivided Family(HUF) property. This amendment is known as the Hindu Succession (Tamilnadu Amendment) Act -1989. By this act, women got equal rights in Hindu Undivided Family property.



Being an examplar in the legislation of women's rights, the then Chief Minister Kaliagnar M. Karunanidhi enacted this amendment act in 1989. Later, an act of this kind was passed by the Indian parliament in 2005.

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